

For Coach Mac — a few things I noticed

Start Upward. Designathon: Code the City. Sparkhouse Uptown opening on Juneteenth, in the building Harvey Gantt used to own. **That's not a small list for one year.** I'm coming Friday to watch and support — not to sell anything. Wanted to bring something useful first.

THE IRONY (AND THE OPPORTUNITY)

Code the City spends two days teaching Charlotte teenagers to build with AI and design thinking. That exact instinct — look hard at a system, find where it's quietly broken, fix it — hasn't been turned on Do Greater's **own** systems yet. Case in point, sitting unclaimed right now:

\$120K

a year in free Google Search ads Do Greater already qualifies for and hasn't applied for — the Google Ad Grant, built for 501(c)(3)s exactly like this one.

GOOGLE AD GRANT — QUICK START *a head start, not a pitch*

- 1 Sign up for **Google for Nonprofits**, verify through TechSoup, then apply for the Ad Grant inside that same portal.
- 2 Set up **GA4 + Google Ads conversion tracking** before anything launches, so every click ties back to a real signup.
- 3 Build ad groups around **specific programs** — Start Upward enrollment, Designathon registration, Sparkhouse Coffee — not a generic "donate" ad. Grant accounts get suspended for weak click-through (under 5%), so tight from day one beats broad.

WHAT'S ACTUALLY HAPPENING UNDERNEATH

REACH

dogreater.org runs on WordPress/Divi, shared Bluehost hosting — C- on performance. Every slow load costs a visitor who never sees the Start Upward or Designathon registration link.

AUDIENCE

YouTube sits at ~4 subscribers. No TikTok, where the 16–24s you actually serve already are. No LinkedIn, where the corporate sponsor conversations happen.

DISCOVERY

Sparkhouse Uptown is built to serve 5,000–10,000 people a year, ages 16–24 — but Search Console was never set up and the Google Business Profile is unclaimed. "Free entrepreneurship program for teens Charlotte" may not surface Do Greater at all.

PIPELINE

Real foot traffic moves through 20,000 square feet every day — coffee counter, showroom, coworking floor — with no QR code, no signup, no follow-up email. A coffee customer or a camp parent has no path to becoming a Start Upward applicant or a returning volunteer.

No pitch here — you left a career at Apple to build this, one program at a time, from Sparkhouse West's 8,000 square feet to Uptown's 20,000 — that's rare enough that WFAE, WCCB, and QCityMetro have all taken notice. Would genuinely love to talk shop, founder to founder, sometime. See you Friday.

Mikey

MADEZ MEDIA

[Mikey — email / phone]